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COP3502C | Fall 2025 | Section 0004

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Mission 1: zeros(n)

I count trailing zeros in $n!$ by adding how many 5s are in all the factors. The recursive rule in my zeros function is: if $n == 0$, return 0; otherwise return $n/5 + \text{zeros}(n/5)$. That naturally adds 5s from 25, 125, etc. Example I tested: $\text{zeros}(100) = 24$.

Mission 2: isPalindrome(str, left, right)

I check the ends and move inward. If $\text{left} \geq \text{right}$, it's a palindrome and I return 1. If $\text{str}[\text{left}] \neq \text{str}[\text{right}]$, I return 0. Otherwise I call isPalindrome on $(\text{left}+1, \text{right}-1)$. With my tests, "racecar" returns 1 and "hello" returns 0.

Mission 3: findMax(arr, start, end) and findMin(arr, start, end)

I use a closed interval $[\text{start}, \text{end}]$. If $\text{start} == \text{end}$, I just return that element. For max, I compare $\text{arr}[\text{start}]$ with the result of findMax on the rest ($\text{start}+1$ to end) and return the bigger one. For min, I do the same but return the smaller one. On my test array $\{5, 2, 9, 1, 7\}$, my functions gave $\text{max} = 9$ and $\text{min} = 1$.

Mission 4: searchRecord(numbers, low, high, value)

This is a recursive binary search with inclusive bounds. If $\text{low} > \text{high}$, I return -1 because it's not found. I set $\text{mid} = \text{low} + (\text{high} - \text{low}) / 2$. If $\text{numbers}[\text{mid}] == \text{value}$, I return mid. If $\text{numbers}[\text{mid}] > \text{value}$, I search the left side by calling $\text{searchRecord}(\text{numbers}, \text{low}, \text{mid} - 1, \text{value})$. Otherwise I search the right side by calling $\text{searchRecord}(\text{numbers}, \text{mid} + 1, \text{high}, \text{value})$. I tested on $[1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11]$. Searching 7 returned index 3. Searching 8 returned -1.